COMP1110 Project Plan rubric check

Checked against *COMP1110 Guidelines for Project Plan* (last updated 21 September 2026), read together with *COMP1110 Group Project Guidelines*. This is a self-review, not a predicted grade.

Creativity of topic (25%)

Requirement: A clear focus that existing work rarely studies, supported by approximately 5-10 relevant sources; an unusual setting alone is insufficient.

In the proposal: Section 3 groups eight verified sources into HKU rules, course allocation, and information disclosure. It distinguishes each cited setting from the joint HKU queue-visibility question and makes a narrow gap claim. Section 1 states the local question.

Remaining check: The gap is supported by a targeted, not exhaustive, literature search. Before Final Report submission, repeat searches for studies of visible university waitlists and revise the claim if a closer paper appears. Do not claim priority or novelty beyond the search.

Connection to computing/data science (25%)

Requirement: Name the main project type and explain how each concept answers the question; show a nontrivial technical core.

In the proposal: Section 2 labels simulation/modelling, specifies timestamp queues, information conditions, stochastic beliefs, decision rule, matched comparison, metrics, and sensitivity checks. Programming is a means, not the contribution.

Remaining check: The plan deliberately leaves exact parameter values and implementation detail for the Final Report. That report must include a worked case, actual run results, checks of queue/capacity rules, and interpretation of sensitivity results.

Clarity of problem/solution (25%)

Requirement: One specific question with context and clear scope, understandable to a classmate outside the group.

In the proposal: Section 1 gives a single italicised primary research question, explains why a student might stay or switch, and excludes add/drop, priority periods, live SIS performance, and system redesign. Section 2 defines the hidden condition as a counterfactual.

Remaining check: Real students can select more than one course; the one-target-course abstraction must remain explicit in the presentation and Final Report. Avoid casually referring to all HKU course selection when discussing model results.

Feasibility, limitations and ethics (10%)

Requirement: Identify data/information needs, access, method, limits, and privacy/consent concerns.

In the proposal: Section 4 uses official rules plus synthetic data, lists unknown preferences/beliefs and omitted rules, proposes sensitivity analysis, and separates demand concentration from actual server congestion. It avoids personal data and flags consent for optional surveys.

Remaining check: Belief and switching-cost values are assumed. Report results over plausible ranges rather than presenting one chosen value as realistic. No server-performance claim without logs.

Formatting, consistency and language (10%)

Requirement: Consistent headings, spacing, fonts/citation style; clear academic prose and locatable references.

In the proposal: The Markdown uses numbered sections, an author-year citation style, a full reference list with DOI/official links, and restrained claims.

Remaining check: Before submission, insert real names and inspect the exported version for a 4-6-page length, table wrapping, readable font, and consistent hanging indents. Markdown itself does not lock pagination.

Timeline and team roles (5%)

Requirement: Dated or week-based milestones with named ownership for five people; “everyone contributes equally” is insufficient.

In the proposal: Section 5 assigns each of five placeholders specific research, modelling, analysis, writing, and presentation tasks from 30 Sep through the presentation period. Technical tasks are shared across Members 2-4.

Remaining check: Replace placeholders with actual names. Confirm the tentative dates against Moodle, especially the Project Plan, progress log, Final Report, and presentation dates.

Final fact and citation check

- **Assignment rules:** the two attached guidelines were read. The Plan guideline specifies 4-6 pages, the six suggested content areas, approximately 5-10 sources, and the six rubric weights above. The Group Project guideline identifies simulation/modelling as a suitable type and does not require a finished application.
- **HKU rules:** first-come-first-served during the August selection period, visible rank/vacancies, several approval runs each day, waiting-list purge, loss of queue place after dropping, and auto-ballot during add/drop are supported by the two official HKU pages cited in Sections 1 and 3. The CCTM priority-period exception is stated and excluded. The one-course decision is labelled a simplification.
- **Academic references:** all six journal articles in the proposal were located by title, authors, venue, year, and DOI in publisher pages, author/institution records, or article PDFs. The two HKU references are official webpages with no DOI. All eight reference-list entries are cited in the text; no uncited item remains.
- **Claims of effects:** the proposal does not claim observed irrationality, actual repeated switching, or SIS overload at HKU. Results from school choice and hospital queues are presented as related evidence or methodological motivation, not direct evidence about HKU.
- **Future verification:** the reported model outcomes will need to be generated and checked during the project. The draft contains no invented HKU data, simulated result, or quotation.